

MON JULY 15 1946

TUES. JUNE 25 1946

Doesn't Think Tornado Wrath of God

Sir: Would Mr. Hewlett please tell me why, if it was God's work, did the tornado strike Sandwich West so hard? Is this where all these bad places are? If it was the wrath of God, why did it not hit those places direct?

I understand the people in that particular district are good, hard-working people trying to get on their feet. Surely God in His goodness and mercy did not want to stop them from that sort. No, no, Mr. Hewlett, I think it was just a thing, one of those things that we are not supposed to understand.

BLENHEIMITE.

Blenheim, Ont.

Thinks Storm Was Sent As Warning

Sir: Regarding the letter in Monday night's paper about the tornado as a warning from God, please let me say that I don't believe it was from the having of a little fun on Sunday. What this city needs is a little fun. The man or woman who works all week at hard labor and then comes home to sit in a house all day, will, in time, become like the man who wrote the letter.

I believe that God was trying to warn us about the atom bomb which I believe will do more harm than good.

A. NIGH.

Tues. July 9 1946

Sees World Disasters As God's Warning

Sir: As a long-standing reader of The Windsor Star, please allow me a little space in the Letter Box to congratulate Lyle E. Talbot on his fine spiritual letter on the Social Gospel and Christ's intent.

I have received many letters from readers asking my opinion of the great disasters that we read about in these days. Is it a sure sign of the coming of Christ again? Yes, it is a sure sign; and I can only express my opinion by the Word of God.

When God drowned the world by the flood in Noah's day, He warned the world's people that it was their terrible wickedness that caused the flood and again, before He destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah He warned the people through Lot that because of their terrible wickedness He would destroy their cities by fire. God did it.

Now He is speaking to every country in the world, through His ministers and preachers, that if they don't cease their terrible wickedness He will destroy the people. We already see He has begun.

In St. Luke 21 we read of wars and commotions. They have come to pass. Nation shall rise against nation. It has come to pass. There are great earthquakes and famines, pestilences, fearful sights, God's people will be persecuted, brought before rulers, put into prisons, desolation by tornadoes. These things are the vengeance of God.

I hope and pray that all people who are living wicked lives will take heed of God's warning and my letter, and save their souls.

P. G. BRIDGE

Newbury, Ont.

Says Tornado Not Work of God

Sir: After reading the letters in The Star letter box written by Lyle E. Talbot and P. G. Bridge. It makes one ponder on our sources of religion. My first opinion on the disasters now happening is that they are not by the hand of God, but by Satan himself. Loosed from his chains, Satan tries to destroy faith and our trust in God.

The recent disaster which hit us very close is an example. I personally knew some of the victims. The Bermans were fine fellows. The young English bride was one of the sweetest women one could meet. Any hour she was expecting to become a mother. Was it God's work to mutilate and destroy that which was sacred and good? Is it still His work, that another young mother in the same house should still be lying in the hospital, and her baby may be dead? Also there is the work of a young English bride and her veteran husband who sacrificed their all to make a home for their tiny baby son, only to be destroyed in a few moments. (God in His goodness and love intervened in this case, for could any of you have gone inside those four walls left standing of Mr. Edgley's house, you would wonder how anyone could have walked out alive. No, fellow readers, God moves in a mysterious way. He wonders to perform. He is slow to anger and tender in His mercies.

There was a case of another very

young couple in that tornado. About 200 feet one side of Mr. Edgley's and about the same distance; the other way is the Drinkwater home (also only the walls left standing). These two young people, very strong in their love and faith in God, knowing of the destruction and the works of the Devil, knelt on the floor of their little home and prayed, while all around the tempest raged. Their home was intact, but for a broken window.

Why Mr. Bridge words his letter as a letter of warning, I do not quite comprehend. Rather, let us have faith and trust in God and He will carry us through. I am the mother of four children and in their simple, small trials I tell them to ask God to help them. I pray from my heart that their faith will not be shattered by fear of the unknown. And that all you readers will know that "God is Love."

JUST A MOTHER.

FRI. JUNE 28 1946

Nurses of Tornado Victim Thanked

Sir: I expected to see a letter concerning this sooner but as nobody has mentioned it before, I feel obliged to do so.

I would like to give a heart-felt thanks and congratulation to the special nurses who took care of the late Nelson Jones, a victim of the recent disastrous tornado. Mr. Jones was in Hotel Dieu Hospital for several days. The nurses taking care of him donated their services gratis. I feel that this is a wonderful gesture. This is really all that need be said. Thanks again, nurses!!!

A FRIEND.

Regards Tornado As Warning From God

Sir: Permit me through your columns to express my heartfelt sorrow to all who have suffered in the tornado. I do pray God to comfort all those who mourn. And I must say it will be a pleasure to help financially.

Now, sir, it is appalling to have to read in our press defiance of God's laws. Recently we had to read of polo games in Jackson Park on Sunday; car races desecrating the Lord's Day. I remember in this city we once had respect for God's holy day. No baseball allowed. But what is not allowed on Sunday these days? And the professed church of God is silent.

Apparently the church has sold out its professed godliness to indifference. Can we wonder in any way at a righteous God pouring out His wrath upon the earth?

Jesus wept over Jerusalem! What with the curse of dice players and bawdy houses and tolerance to gambling devices, I think the time has come for another Abraham, to plead with God to spare the city. Will he find 50 righteous people?

I pray God to awaken all Christian people to pray, as I know of many who were driven to pray during the tornado.

R. HEWLETT

1075 Wellington Avenue.

WED. JULY 3 1946

Tornado Victim Grateful For Help Received

Sir: Would you please print the letter which follows in your Letter Box page? It is a letter of thanks to a club that I cannot get in touch with.

Dear Friendship Club:

I received the letter you left at Grace Hospital and I wish to thank you, both for your gift and for your well wishing.

At the present my wife is still unconscious but I'm sure she would wish me to say that it is people like you who make up all the kindness and helpfulness that prevail in the world wherever disaster strikes. Without the help we received we could not survive the utter destruction without a long, hard struggle.

But, no matter what I try to say, it all adds up in the end to my sincerest thanks to you and all the others who have helped us who were struck by the tornado.

RAYMOND FOX.

Lawn Party Sponsors Express Thanks

Sir: The members of the committee in charge of the lawn party given for The Windsor Star Tornado Relief Fund wish to thank everyone who helped to make it a success. Special thanks to Miss Tapeson of The Star for publicity; Rev. M. C. Davies for the loan of tables, chairs, etc., from his church, and his very interesting address; Joe Jewhurst for his record player; Jimmy King and his orchestra; Ted Robertson for Scottish dances; Andy Adamson, pipes; John Saunders, accordion; the various stores for prizes donated, and all the neighbors who helped in every possible way.

MRS. ORLEY DRESSER.

(For the Committee in Charge.)

Says Windsor Tragedy Sets Us Thinking

Sir: The catastrophe that hit Windsor so suddenly has set us all thinking. It has done more than that, it has set us all thinking more sympathetically, and perhaps more seriously, than ever before. It has proved too, that humanity is still kind, still generous, and still eager to help wherever there is need. We here, in Kent County, have lost much of the crop that took so many hours of hard work to plant. In many cases chickens and even cows were drowned—but as I heard a lady say yesterday: "What is our loss, compared with those who lost dear ones?" A large new barn and other valuable buildings on their farm!

Then, too, we were talking about it today, and compared Windsor's tragedy to that of poor, brave little, blighted England—and we marvelled that, with years of nightly horror, when not a few, but hundreds of buildings were razed each night, the people still held on! There, too, people were, and still are, undernourished, worried and heart sick. I wonder if we have been sympathetic and understanding enough of their suffering.

Some time ago, a letter appeared in the Letter Box, telling of the plentiful supply of luscious, delicious food, a relative had partaken of in England. On the same day, we listened to a woman commentator who had just returned to over here from over there. She described the all day long queues of housewives, waiting to see if their number was up in order to obtain a few ounces of meat or perhaps two eggs. It seems in some countries the number system is used, said this lady: "There are three classes of people, those who are wealthy, and can buy food at fabulous, unheard of prices on the black market, those who have relatives living on farms, and those who have neither wealth, nor farm kin. Those people are just about on the starvation list." So, you see!

It was not kind, it was most unfair, to write such a letter, though surely those of us who can read and listen to radio talks, or who have relatives in England, will realize that very few people paid much attention to such obvious nonsense.

A tragedy like that of Windsor too, has made us all perhaps more conscious of the fact that with all our scientific discoveries, our wonderful education, and yes, our ego, we are entirely dependent upon God, the Creator! In just a few seconds, our plans may be wrecked, and what we have achieved may be torn away! We, in Kent County, are sorrowing with our neighbor county.

MRS. WYNNE BUNNING.
Cedar Springs, Ont.

Churchmen Sympathize With Disaster Victims

Sir: At a meeting of the executive committee of the Diocese of Huron, held on Friday, June 21, a resolution was passed to the following effect:

"That this executive committee of the Diocese of Huron desires to place on record its sincere sympathy with the residents of the Counties of Kent and Essex in the appalling disaster which has fallen upon them, and assures them of our prayers."

I was asked to convey this information to you for insertion in your paper.

ARCHDEACON W. J. DOHERTY,
Secretary-Treasurer, Synod of the
Diocese of Huron,
London, Ont.

Has Words of Comfort For Sufferers

Sir: To those who have lost their loved ones and homes in the tragedy of the tornado, I should like to bring a word of comfort.

The sympathetic touch from our fellow men, and hands that go forth to help in time of trouble, are the God spark that dwells in us all. Yet, each stricken individual needs far more than this. His sorrow, such that none of us can heal, remains.

Here "Hope" rings her highest note, and bids the heavy hearts look up, for help cometh from on high. Reach out for God's hand and, clasping it, know that out of life's sorrows new life is born and greater peace than you have known before.

"Beauty for ashes," is God's promise (Isaiah 61-3), and Christ assures us: "I will not leave you comfortless, I will come to you." (John 14-18.)

May the silent prayers of every man and woman ascend to our Father, to ask His help for all the suffering people here, and all over the world. Good hath greater power than evil, and prayer hath greater power than all the raging elements that afflict mankind.

WOMAN OF WINDSOR.